were being forced. Notices had gone to such shareholders setting a deadline for 15 September. He ended with a plea to save a worthy national cause.[93]

A week later, Krishna Aiyangar argued that it would be foolish to liquidate the company at this juncture. Capital was being raised from defaulting shareholders and the sale of donation tickets was encouraging. He urged existing shareholders to invest further since it was in their own interest to do so. Pointing out that there were about 1,600 shareholders holding only one share, they could, by subscribing to an additional share, acquire voting rights. 'The goodwill and reputation of our presidency,' he declared, 'is in their hands.'[94]

To the annual report mentioned above, signed by nine directors, Krishna Aiyangar, as honorary secretary, had already appended an appeal pleading for Rs 2 lakh in two months. 'This was the last decisive appeal', he said.[95]

Even before the directors could meet to decide on forfeiting such shares, Krishna Aiyangar said, several shareholders had written saying that they had indeed paid up while others communicated that they were remitting one instalment and promising to pay in full by 1 October. In this context, he said the meeting of the directors had been postponed to 4 October.[96]

The date to take a final call on the company's fate was fixed for 18 September 1909.[97] The single-point agenda was 'to consider and decide whether the company should be wound up or its business carried on and if so how and under what arrangements'[98] in the light of the directors' report. But the meeting could not be held due to lack of quorum, possibly an indication of loss of hope among the shareholders.[99] Meanwhile S. Annaswami Aiyar, a signatory to the September 1909 directors' report, and a supporter of the company's continued existence, had changed his mind and was advocating liquidation.[100]

The postponed meeting took place a week or so later, on 25 September.[101] Seeing a glimmer of hope with new shares being taken, unpaid shares paid up and vigorous canvassing going on to raise capital, the shareholders decided to continue business until the end of the year. They